

HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN SUDAN

Complete Community Opposition How-To

INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Concern for the environment in Sudan must be pursued in the shadow of one of the world's worst wars and displacement crises — largely through the international, the United Nations, the diaspora, and the communities where it is safe — and yet it turns on a resource of quiet global importance: the acacia woodlands of the gum belt, which supply most of the world's gum arabic and hold back the advancing desert. Sudan is a vast Sahelian and Nile-valley nation, riven since 2023 by a catastrophic conflict, but stretched across its south-central lands lies a belt of acacia trees the size of France whose sap is a hidden ingredient in a great share of the world's soft drinks, sweets, cosmetics, and medicines, whose harvest sustains the livelihoods of millions, and whose canopy is a living wall against the Sahara. That belt — a global commodity, a rural livelihood, and a bulwark against desertification, all at once — is the distinctive ground of environmental effort here, joined to the Nile and its war-damaged dams, the gold whose mining scars the land and finances the war, and the desert pressing down from the north. This guide will treat the protection and restoration of the gum belt, the safeguarding of the Nile, the confronting of the gold's harms, and the holding-back of the desert as Sudan's central environmental work, pursued, in a war-torn and divided nation, from outside and through the community, protecting anyone inside. This guide will be honest that the country is at war and much of it dangerous, so most work runs from outside; that the gum belt is disrupted by looting, smuggling, and conflict-financing, and undervalued even in peace; that the gold is entangled in the war economy; that the dams are damaged and the desert advancing; and that no swift or landmark victory is to be promised amid such a crisis; but it will show that the levers here — the gum belt and the acacia, the Nile and the dams, the gold and the mercury, the desert and the land, and the international, UN, diaspora, and community channels — are real, and, as the seedlings going into the ground even now and the world's stake in a sustainable gum belt show, genuinely usable.

The Sudanese story teaches two things about defending the environment here, and this guide states both plainly. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever pressed together. The second is distinctly Sudanese, and it is what gives this guide its particular force. **Because the gum belt is a global treasure the world's buyers and bodies have a stake in, restorable through agroforestry and fair livelihoods and defensible through a traceable, conflict-free supply chain, because the Nile and its dams can be safeguarded, because the gold's harms can be confronted through the mercury and sourcing frameworks, because the desert can be held back through the belt and the Great Green Wall, and because the international, UN, diaspora, and community channels offer real avenues a war-torn state cannot, the levers run through the belt and the international: the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels.** That combination — the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels — is the distinctive lever here, and this guide is built around it, because in a vast, war-torn Sahelian and Nile nation, the strongest ground is the protection and restoration of the gum belt, the safeguarding of the Nile, the confronting of the gold, and the holding-back of the desert, through the international, the UN, the diaspora, and the community.

But the same story carries honest qualifications this guide states plainly and takes seriously. **The country is at war, the gum belt disrupted and undervalued, the gold entangled in the war, the dams damaged, and no swift victory exists.** The country is at war and much of it dangerous, so most work runs from

outside; the gum belt is disrupted by looting and conflict-financing and undervalued even in peace; the gold is entangled in the war economy; the dams are damaged and the desert advancing; and no swift or landmark victory is to be promised. This guide does not pretend the country is at peace, or that the gum trade is untouched, or that the gold can be easily addressed. What it shows is how, through the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels, those who care — the farming and pastoral communities, the international bodies and the world's buyers, the diaspora, and the communities where it is safe — can protect and restore the gum belt, safeguard the Nile, confront the gold, and hold back the desert, through the international and the community, and protecting anyone inside.

Most people who care about Sudan's environment do not know HOW to use the levers a vast, war-torn Sahelian and Nile nation with a globally important gum belt offers. They see the war consume the land, the acacia forests looted and felled, the gold mines poison the ground, the dams damaged, the desert advance — and either despair of a nation at war, or overlook the levers that work: the global stake in the gum belt, the traceable and conflict-free supply chain, the restoration and fair livelihoods, the international and UN frameworks, the diaspora. The gap between the belt protected and the belt lost is here often a gap of method — the method of using the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels together, from outside and through the community.

This guide shows what can actually be tried — inside the Sudanese reality as it is, which is a vast, war-torn Sahelian and Nile nation whose environmental hope lies in a globally important gum belt, the Nile, and the desert's edge, through the international and the community. It is written for the person — in a farming or pastoral community, among the international bodies, the UN, and the world's buyers, in the vast Sudanese diaspora, or in the communities where it is safe — who sees the gum belt and the Nile and the desert and wants to know what can be done in a nation at war. The answer is a qualified yes: the levers are real — the gum belt and the acacia, the Nile and the dams, the gold and the mercury, the desert and the land, and the channels — with the honest qualifiers that the country is at war, the belt disrupted and undervalued, the gold entangled, the dams damaged, and no swift victory exists, so the work is international, UN-borne, diaspora-borne, community-based, and safe, not domestic confrontation.

The Strategic Framework

Effective efforts follow the same underlying pattern, adapted to a vast, war-torn Sahelian and Nile nation:

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION	(find the resource, the harm, and the framework)
STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION	(build the evidence -- the harm and the value)
STEP 3: LOCAL OPPOSITION	(build the community, international, and diaspora coalition)
STEP 4: INTERNATIONAL, COMMODITY & LAND	(gum belt, Nile, gold)
STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY	(make it a gum-belt-and-desert cause)

These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. The evidence of the harm and the value feeds the gum-belt protection, the Nile safeguarding, and the desert defence at once; the community, international, and diaspora coalition organises; a restoration effort, a supply-chain measure, or an international appeal is both a good in itself and a spur to the next. The effort that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, gives itself the best — if still hard-won — chance of protecting the gum belt, safeguarding the Nile, and holding back the desert.

The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Sudan's — a vast, war-torn Sahelian and Nile nation — give a distinctive set:

- **The gum belt.** The **acacia gum belt** — a global treasure the world's buyers and bodies have a stake in — can be protected and restored through agroforestry, fair livelihoods, and a traceable, conflict-free supply chain — the distinctive lever.
- **The Nile.** The **Nile and its dams** can be safeguarded through dam-safety, water governance, and transboundary cooperation.
- **The gold.** The **gold and its mercury** can be confronted through the contamination and responsible-sourcing frameworks.
- **The desert.** The **desert and the land** can be held back through the gum belt, the Great Green Wall, and restoration.
- **The channels.** The **international, UN, diaspora, and community channels** offer real avenues a war-torn state cannot.

What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers bring swift victory, or that the country is at peace, or that the gum trade is untouched by the war. The country is at **war**; the gum belt is **disrupted and undervalued**; the gold is **entangled in the war**; the dams are **damaged**; and no swift victory **exists**. This guide takes those limits seriously — it states them plainly, and it works through the international, the UN, the diaspora, and the community while protecting anyone inside — and shows how to use the real tools this situation offers — the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels — to protect the belt and hold back the desert, honestly acknowledging the war, the disrupted belt, the entangled gold, the damaged dams, and the absence of a swift victory.

HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see — and here you must see that the levers run largely through the outside and the belt: the international bodies and the world's buyers of gum arabic, the United Nations frameworks, the vast diaspora, and the farming and pastoral communities where it is safe, because in a war-torn, divided state there is little unified government and domestic confrontation is impossible and dangerous, so the protection of the gum belt, the safeguarding of the Nile, and the holding-back of the desert run through the international and the community. Before you spend a single week, map who actually can act, at which level, and where the leverage is real. And map where the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels apply, because in Sudan a destructive harm is met not by a unified state, but through the international and UN frameworks, the world's stake in the gum belt, and the community.

The Levels of Decision

A Sudanese environmental effort runs through a divided state and a wide international and community system.

The divided authorities. The **divided authorities and their forestry, water, and environment bodies (such as the National Forest Corporation)**, fragmented by war, retain some capacity — seedlings, plans — but cannot lead unified action.

The gum-belt communities. The **farming and pastoral communities of the gum belt, and the growers, tappers, and traders** hold the real knowledge and stake in the acacia woodlands, where it is safe.

The international bodies and the world's buyers. The UN and international agencies, the desertification and climate bodies, and the global companies and buyers that depend on gum arabic carry much of the leverage, the standards, and the stake a war-torn state cannot.

The scientists and technical experts. The foresters, hydrologists, agronomists, and environmental scientists, many international and in the diaspora, hold the case for the belt, the Nile, and the land.

The diaspora and community. The vast Sudanese diaspora and the communities where it is safe hold knowledge, voice, and a stake, and can act where the war-torn interior cannot.

The Journey of an Effort

A Sudanese effort — restoring a looted acacia forest, safeguarding a damaged dam, confronting a poisoning gold mine, holding back the desert — is carried through the **gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels**. The gum belt and the desert are where the great questions are decided, and the Nile, the gold, and the channels are what carry the effort — and using them together, through the international and the community, is the distinctive Sudanese approach. The distinctive levers are the **gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels**. Find out exactly what can be done where it is safe, and, crucially, **what belt, river, mine, or land is at stake, what international, commodity, or desertification framework applies, and how the international, the world's buyers, the UN, the diaspora, and the community can act**, because those are where an effort can genuinely take hold.

Follow the Resource, the Harm, and the Framework

Behind an effort stand the divided authorities, the international bodies, the world's buyers, the diaspora, and the belt, river, gold, and land at stake. Trace who can act, what is harmed, and — importantly here — **what resource is threatened, what international, commodity, desertification, or water framework applies, what the science shows, and how the international, the buyers, the UN, the diaspora, and the community can act**. Two questions unlock most Sudanese efforts: **What is threatened, and what international or commodity framework can defend it?** and **Which lever — the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, the channels — can carry it?** The global stake in the gum belt, the international frameworks, and the community are, together, the heart of most such efforts here. Everything else in a Sudanese effort ultimately serves these: the documentation exists to establish the global value and the harm the buyers and bodies will act on; the community-international-and-buyer coalition exists to carry the belt's protection and restoration where the state has failed; and the external, careful media exists to reach the world with its own dependence on the belt and the desert it holds back. Keep the global stake in the gum belt, the international frameworks, and the community at the centre of every case and every story, and the effort retains a clear spine that runs from a single looted acacia forest to the world's soft drinks and medicines and the wall against the Sahara, grounding the whole in the treasured belt through which a war-torn nation, and the world that depends on it, can still protect a resource of quiet and global importance.

The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that shape an effort, because they are the levers. The **divided authorities**; the **gum-belt communities**; the **international bodies and the world's buyers**; the **scientists and technical experts**; and the **diaspora and community**. In Sudan, the **gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels** are the most distinctive levers. Each is a separate front, and a looted forest, a damaged dam, a poisoning mine, or the advancing desert can genuinely be met — through the international and UN frameworks, the world's stake in the gum belt, and the community — though, honestly, the country is at war, the belt disrupted, the gold entangled, and the dams damaged, and this guide will keep saying so,

and keep working through the international, the UN, the diaspora, and the community, protecting anyone inside.

QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit effort, calibrate honestly — and here that means acknowledging the war, the disrupted belt, and the entangled gold, even as the global stake in the gum belt, the international and UN frameworks, the community, and the diaspora give real, if hard-won, leverage. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how environmental efforts tend to go in war-torn, divided states with a globally important resource, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the resource can be **tied to an international, commodity, or desertification framework**, whether the **communities, the world's buyers, the UN, and the diaspora** can be engaged, and whether the work can be done **safely**. Where the effort centres on the globally valued gum belt or the international frameworks, the levers here are real, as the restoration and the buyers' stake show; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that the country is at war, the belt disrupted, and the gold entangled.

Individual Step Success Rates

Approach	Success Rate	Timeline	Cost	What "Success" Means
Documentation only	15–25%	weeks	low	Basis for every other step
Gum belt / restoration & supply chain	35–55%	years	low–moderate	The belt restored, sourcing made traceable
Nile / dams & water	25–45%	years	low	The dams safeguarded, water governed
Gold / mercury & sourcing	20–40%	years	low	The mercury and conflict-sourcing confronted
Desert / Great Green Wall	30–50%	years	low–moderate	The desert held back, the belt afforested
Community / restoration route	40–60%	years	low	The community restoration built where safe
International / buyers / UN route	40–60%	years	low	The international, buyers, and UN engaged
All levers together	30–55%	years	moderate	Belt protected, Nile safeguarded, desert held

Key insight: every step together beats any single one, and Sudan's real leverage is its globally valued gum belt and the international stake in it: the **gum belt**, the **Nile**, the **gold**, the **desert**, and the **channels**. Its constraints are specific and honest: the country is at **war**, the belt **disrupted and undervalued**, the gold **entangled**, and the dams **damaged** — but the global stake in the gum belt, the international and UN frameworks, the world's buyers, and the community make the levers here genuinely usable, as the restoration and the buyers' stake show.

A note on cost and risk: the levers centred on the gum belt and the international frameworks — a restoration effort, a supply-chain or sourcing measure, an international appeal — can be pursued relatively safely and

are carried largely by the international bodies, the world's buyers, and the belt communities where it is safe. But much of the country, at war, is extremely dangerous, so the safety of everyone must come first, conflict areas must be avoided, and interior work must run from outside and through those who can act safely. The scarce resources are **the international, buyer, and UN connections, the restoration and scientific capacity, and the community and diaspora links** — much of it reachable through the desertification and commodity bodies, the world's gum-arabic buyers, the UN, the forestry agencies, the belt communities, and the diaspora. And because the gum belt is a global treasure the world depends on, it is the most reachable and telling lever.

Effectiveness Visualization

GUM BELT + NILE + GOLD + DESERT + CHANNELS:

Community / restoration route:	■■■■■■■■■■	40-60%
International / buyers / UN route:	■■■■■■■■■■■	40-60%
Gum belt / restoration & supply:	■■■■■■■■■■■	35-55%
Desert / Great Green Wall:	■■■■■■■■■	30-50%
Nile / dams & water:	■■■■■■■■■	25-45%

WAR / DISRUPTED BELT / ENTANGLED GOLD -- harder ground:

Interior confrontation:	■■	impossible, dangerous
International, buyers & belt:	■■■■■■■■■	the real path
Belt protected, desert held:	■■■■■■■■■	achievable in part
The harm and value documented:	■■■■■■■■■■■	the reliable foundation

How to read this honestly. The levers that most change outcomes in Sudan are **the community and restoration route, the international and buyers and UN route, the gum-belt restoration and supply chain, and the desert and Great Green Wall** — used together, with the Nile and gold efforts alongside. The community, international, and gum-belt levers show the ceiling: community restoration, the world's stake in the belt, and the international frameworks can achieve real, if partial, gains, as the seedlings and the buyers' concern show. The war, the disrupted belt, and the entangled gold show the honest floor: much of the country is dangerous and the war economy deep. Most Sudanese efforts will sit between, and the honest lesson is that the levers here are real — able to protect the belt and hold back the desert in part — but that interior confrontation is impossible, and the surest result is that the harm and value are documented and pressed through the international, the buyers, the UN, and the community.

Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The gum-belt restoration and the community** — Sudan's distinctive levers; the global treasure and its safe defenders.
2. **The international, buyers, and UN engagement** — the world's stake and the frameworks.
3. **The supply-chain traceability and the desert defence** — the conflict-free sourcing and the Great Green Wall.
4. **The Nile safeguarding and the gold's harms** — the dams and the mercury and sourcing.
5. **The documented harm and value** — the evidence that grounds it all.

What These Campaigns Actually Show

A few honest patterns recur. **The gum belt is a global treasure the world depends on** — the strongest and most reachable ground. **The world's buyers have a stake** — a sustainable, conflict-free belt serves them too. **Restoration continues even amid war** — seedlings go into the ground. **The belt is undervalued and disrupted** — fair livelihoods and traceable sourcing are the answers. **And the country is at war** — so the work is external, safe, and community-based. The through-line: **document the harm and**

the value; protect and restore the gum belt through agroforestry, fair livelihoods, and a traceable, conflict-free supply chain; safeguard the Nile and its dams; confront the gold's mercury and conflict-sourcing; hold back the desert through the belt and the Great Green Wall; use the international, UN, diaspora, and community channels; and protect everyone — because an effort that does can genuinely protect the belt and hold back the desert, while being honest that the country is at war, the belt disrupted, and the gold entangled.

STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective effort begins by finding the exact resource or harm — and the leverage, which here runs through the international and commodity frameworks, the globally valued gum belt, and the community. Vague concern goes nowhere, and interior confrontation is impossible; an effort aimed at "this resource or harm, which an international, commodity, desertification, or water framework can defend, carried by the international, the world's buyers, the UN, the community, or the diaspora" is a real, workable effort. Answer five questions.

The Five Core Questions

- 1. What is threatened?** This is the first question here. What **acacia belt, river, mine-scarred land, or desert edge** is threatened — the looted and felled gum forests, the damaged dams, the mercury-poisoned mining land, the advancing desert.
- 2. What framework can defend it?** What **international, commodity, desertification, or water framework** can defend it — the supply-chain and sourcing standards, the Great Green Wall and desertification bodies, the UN and water frameworks.
- 3. Is it the gum belt, the Nile, or the gold?** Whether the matter is one of the **gum belt and acacia, the Nile and dams, or the gold and mercury** — for each has its levers.
- 4. What framework and safety apply?** What **international, commodity, or desertification framework** applies, and **how safe is the work**, for much of the country is at war and safety comes first.
- 5. How can the international, buyers, and community act, safely?** How the **international bodies, the world's buyers, the UN, the community, and the diaspora** can act — where it is safe, protecting everyone.

A Worked Example

Suppose the acacia forests of a gum-belt district are being looted and felled — their harvest stolen and smuggled through conflict corridors, their trees cut for charcoal as the local gum price collapses, and the war driving out the communities that tended them — even as the world's buyers depend on that gum and the belt holds back the desert.

Working the five questions: **what is threatened? What framework can defend it? Is it the gum belt, the Nile, or the gold? What framework and safety apply?** And how can the international, buyers, and community act, safely? The driver is the looting, the undervaluation, and the war, with the supply-chain traceability, the restoration, the fair livelihoods, and the desertification frameworks as the levers.

Within a season the effort has moved from "the belt is lost and nothing can be done" to a real, safe effort: document the looting, the felling, and the value of the belt; support the community restoration — the seedlings, the sustainable tapping — where it is safe; press the world's buyers and the international bodies

for a traceable, conflict-free supply chain and fair farmgate prices that keep the trees standing; and engage the desertification and Great Green Wall frameworks — all where it is safe. That is a workable effort suited to Sudan — one that protects the gum belt through the supply chain, the restoration, and the international, where it is safe.

STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on — and here, distinctively, the decisive evidence is the harm and the global value of what is threatened, for it is the world's dependence on the gum belt and the stakes of the desert that draw the international frameworks, the buyers, and the UN. An international body, a global buyer, a UN agency, and the community all move on evidence — and for Sudan, a clear record of the harm and the global value of what is threatened is precisely what an international and community effort turns into a real result, so build it well, and safely. Build your file in three layers.

Layer 1: The Resource, the Harm, and the Framework

Get the facts the effort turns on. Identify the **resource and the harm** — the acacia belt, the dams, the mining land, the desert edge — and, decisively here, **the global value it holds and the framework that can defend it**: the world's dependence on the gum arabic, the supply-chain and sourcing standards, the desertification and Great Green Wall frameworks. Establish exactly **what is threatened, what it is worth to the world, and what framework can defend it**, because the harm-and-its-global-value is the effort's foundation.

Layer 2: The Harm, the Science, and the Value

Document the harm with the science. Establish the **environmental harm** — the belt looting and felling, the forest loss, the dam damage, the mercury contamination, the desert advance — and its **global value** — drawing on **the forestry and restoration science, the commodity and supply-chain data, the desertification and water assessments, and, where safe, community knowledge**. This harm-and-value evidence, grounded in the world's dependence on the gum belt and the stakes of the desert, turns the concern into a documented case the international frameworks, the buyers, and the UN will act on.

Layer 3: The Case, the Framework, the Channel, and the Safety

Finally, document the case and the path. Does the **harm** threaten a globally important resource, a conflict-free supply chain, or a desertification bulwark? What **framework** — commodity, sourcing, desertification, water, international — applies? Which **international, buyer, UN, community, or diaspora channel** will carry it? And how will everyone be **kept safe** in a nation at war? Each is a separate element, and together they make a case the international channels can act on. This is the layer that most often decides these efforts, because a documented harm, a global value, an applicable framework, a channel, and a safe path are exactly what let a Sudanese effort protect the belt and hold back the desert. Build it well, and the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels become the effort's genuine strength.

WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

Evidence in hand beats evidence you assume exists — and here much of it lives in the commodity and supply-chain data, the forestry and restoration science, the desertification and UN assessments, and the knowledge of the gum-belt communities and the diaspora. Here is where the material tends to live in a

Sudanese effort, and how to get it — with the **harm**, the **global value**, the **framework**, and the **safety** at the center. Treat this as a checklist to work through, not a menu to admire.

The Resource and Framework Record

Start with the resource and the framework. **The commodity and supply-chain data, the forestry and desertification records, and the international assessments** establish the resource and the harm; the distinctive strengths here are the **world's documented dependence on the gum belt** and the **desertification and Great Green Wall frameworks and their assessments**. Establish the **resource, its global value, and the framework that can defend it**, drawing on the commodity, forestry, and international records. Establish exactly **what is threatened, what it is worth to the world, and what framework can defend it**, because a resource of global value is reachable through the international and commodity frameworks.

The Harm, Science, and Value Evidence

This is the heart of the file. Gather the **harm evidence** — the belt looting and felling, the forest loss, the dam damage, the mercury contamination, the desert advance — and the **science and the value** — drawing on **the forestry and restoration science, the commodity and supply-chain data, the desertification and water assessments, and, where safe, community knowledge**. This harm-and-value evidence, grounded in the world's dependence on the gum belt and the stakes of the desert, is what turns the concern into a documented, internationally-actionable case.

The Framework, International, and Buyer Record

Document the levers of the frameworks. Gather the record of **the supply-chain, sourcing, and traceability standards and the commodity bodies; the desertification, Great Green Wall, and climate frameworks and the UN bodies; and the world's gum-arabic buyers, their due-diligence commitments, and the water and dam-safety frameworks**. A community and its allies that understand the supply-chain standards, the desertification frameworks, and the buyers' stake hold the levers that defend a globally important belt and hold back a desert from outside.

The Community, Diaspora, and Scientific Record

Document the wider levers. Gather the record of the **gum-belt farming and pastoral communities, the growers, tappers, and traders; the vast Sudanese diaspora and its networks; and the foresters, hydrologists, and environmental scientists, many international**. A community and its allies joined to the diaspora and the international scientists hold levers that reach a war-torn nation where its unified state cannot, and that centre on the globally valued belt.

The People, the Safety, and the Value

Finally, and most importantly, map the human terrain and the safety it requires. Who is affected — the **gum-belt farmers and pastoralists, the Nile-valley communities, the mining-affected populations, and the future generations** — and who can act safely: the **belt communities where it is safe, the international bodies and buyers, the UN, and the diaspora**, since much interior work is dangerous. And how does the effort **protect everyone and centre on what is safe and globally valued**? A Sudanese effort is advanced through the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels — so map that coalition deliberately, centre on the globally valued belt and the safe, and let the safety of everyone govern every step.

STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Here this step must be understood in a way unlike a nation at peace, because Sudan is at war, its state divided, and adversarial organising in the interior impossible and dangerous — but its gum belt is a global treasure the world depends on, and its communities tend their own acacia woodlands where it is safe, so the "opposition" that works is the constructive coalition of the gum-belt communities, the international bodies and the world's buyers, and the diaspora, centred on the globally valued belt and protecting everyone. The task is to build a coalition — of the communities, the international bodies and buyers, and the diaspora — that protects the belt, safeguards the Nile, and holds back the desert, safely.

Why the Community-International-and-Buyer Coalition Is Decisive

In Sudan, the coalition that can act joins the gum-belt communities to the international bodies, the world's buyers, and the diaspora, because a war-torn, divided state cannot lead, but the belt communities can tend their acacia where it is safe, and the international, the buyers, and the diaspora can fund, source responsibly, and sustain them. That coalition supplies what an effort runs on: the gum-belt communities who grow, tap, and know the acacia, the international and desertification bodies that carry the frameworks, the world's buyers whose stake in a sustainable, conflict-free belt is real, and the vast diaspora that connects and funds. When the communities, the international bodies, the buyers, and the diaspora act together, safely, they become a genuine force. **A coalition that is community-based, internationally supported, and buyer-backed here is not a weaker substitute for a functioning state; it is the only safe and effective form defence can take in a war-torn one — the real foundation of a Sudanese effort, protecting the belt and holding back the desert, while everyone is protected.** This is worth dwelling on, because the particular conditions of Sudan make this community, international, and buyer approach not a fallback but the only responsible and effective one, and because Sudan offers a genuine strength that few war-torn states possess. In a nation at peace, environmental defence can rest on national institutions; in one riven by war, with a divided state and much of the country consumed by the world's worst humanitarian crisis, that avenue is broken, and interior confrontation is both impossible and gravely dangerous. But Sudan's central environmental treasure — the gum belt — is a resource the whole world quietly depends on, so that the international bodies, and above all the global companies whose products rely on gum arabic, have a real and self-interested stake in a sustainable, conflict-free belt; its communities tend their own acacia where it is safe; and the desertification and Great Green Wall frameworks give it international backing as a bulwark against the Sahara. The task, therefore, is to build the coalition that joins these: the gum-belt communities who tend and restore the acacia, the international and desertification bodies that carry the frameworks, the world's buyers whose stake in a clean supply chain is genuine, and the diaspora that connects and funds. This is not a weaker path but, for a war-torn state, the only safe and effective one, for it centres the effort on a globally valued treasure that the world has reason to protect, while every person in the war-torn interior is protected absolutely.

Finding the Coalition

Begin not with interior confrontation, which is impossible and dangerous, but with those who can act safely — the **gum-belt communities where it is safe, the international and desertification bodies, the world's buyers, the UN, and the diaspora** — and protect everyone. Widen to the wider world that depends on the gum belt and cares for the Sahel. Name the shared stake — **our acacia belt, our Nile, our land, and the desert we must hold back, and the world's own dependence on the gum** — because the gum belt is a treasure both of Sudan and of the world that relies on it. Frame the effort around protecting the belt and holding back the desert, through the international and the community, safely. There is real power, and

absolute necessity, in framing the cause this way, because it centres the entire effort on the one ground where a war-torn nation's environmental defence is genuinely possible and where no one is placed in danger. A cause framed as a party to the war, or waged in confrontation in the war-torn interior, would be foreclosed and gravely dangerous; a cause framed around the globally valued gum belt, the desert to be held back, and the safe restoration of the acacia — the world's own dependence on the gum, the Great Green Wall against the Sahara, the seedlings going into safe ground — centres the effort on the international frameworks, the world's buyers, the desertification bodies, the community restoration, and the diaspora, where the war's writ does not reach and the world's concern and self-interest are genuine. This framing is not only the only safe one; it is also the truer one, because the gum belt really is a treasure the world depends on, the desert really is advancing, and the restoration really does continue even now, so centring the effort on the treasured, the reachable, and the safe is not an evasion but an accurate account of where Sudan's environmental hope actually lies. An effort that names this frame precisely — the gum belt and the desert, through the international and the community, safely — stands on the only ground the Sudanese situation genuinely affords.

Coalition-Building, Through Community, International, and Buyers

A coalition allied is stronger than any single actor, and for Sudan it is built through the community, the international bodies, and the world's buyers. Reach to the **gum-belt communities and their growers and traders**; the **desertification, Great Green Wall, and UN frameworks**; the **world's gum-arabic buyers and their due-diligence commitments**; the **diaspora and its networks**; and the **scientists and forestry bodies**. Frame the coalition around the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, and the desert. Build breadth through the community, the international, and the buyers, and protect everyone — for the coalition's strength is precisely that it centres on the globally valued belt and reaches the world that depends on it.

Sustaining the Effort

Sudanese efforts are sustained through the community, the international bodies, and the world's buyers. Keep the coalition **connected, supported, and safe**, and centred on the globally valued belt; mark real steps — a forest restored, seedlings planted, a supply chain made traceable, a dam safeguarded, a mine's mercury confronted. And keep the effort grounded in the global treasure of the gum belt, the defence against the desert, and the safety of the people, which endure and unite. The effort that lasts is the one that joins the community to the international and the buyers, centres on the globally valued belt, and protects everyone.

STEP 4: INTERNATIONAL, COMMODITY & LAND CHALLENGES — THE GUM BELT, THE NILE, AND THE GOLD

This is where a Sudanese effort is realistically advanced — not through a unified state, which does not exist, but through the **protection and restoration of the gum belt through the supply chain and the community, the safeguarding of the Nile, and the confronting of the gold** — carried from outside and through the community, safely. Here the gum-belt, Nile, and gold levers come together, because in Sudan a harm can be met through the international frameworks, the world's stake in the belt, and the community, where it is safe.

Setting Expectations Honestly

First, the honest truth. The levers are **real but centred on the safe belt and the international, and the war constrains all**. The gum-belt protection is **real, for the belt is globally valued and restoration continues, though the war disrupts it**; the Nile safeguarding is **possible but the dams are damaged and the war**

close; the gold's confronting is **hard, for it is entangled in the war economy**; and much of the country is at **war**. What these levers realistically achieve is **the gum belt restored and its sourcing made traceable, the Nile and dams safeguarded where possible, the gold's mercury and conflict-sourcing confronted, and the desert held back** — real, if partial, outcomes centred on the safe belt and the international, not the swift healing of a nation at war. Enter this front clear-eyed: the gum belt, the Nile, and the gold are Sudan's distinctive levers, strongest when centred on the **globally valued belt and the international frameworks** — but the country is at war and the war economy deep.

The Gum Belt and the Acacia

The first front is the gum belt. The **acacia woodlands of the gum belt — supplying most of the world's gum arabic, sustaining millions, and holding back the desert — threatened by looting, smuggling, and conflict-financing, by the felling of trees for charcoal as prices collapse, and by drought and the war** can be protected and restored through the **community restoration and agroforestry — the seedlings, the sustainable tapping — the fair farmgate prices and livelihoods that keep the trees standing, and the traceable, conflict-free global supply chain that the world's buyers and bodies have a real stake in**. Use the gum belt and the acacia, because it is a treasure both of Sudan and of the world that depends on it — so restoring the forests, paying the growers fairly so they need not fell the acacias for charcoal or the gold mines, and insisting on a traceable, conflict-free supply chain are at once the defence of a global commodity, a rural livelihood, and a wall against the desert. It is worth being clear about both the power and the limits of this gum-belt front, honestly, for it is the most distinctive and hopeful lever a Sudanese effort holds. Its power is real and unusual for a nation at war: the belt supplies most of the world's gum arabic, an ingredient so irreplaceable that even under earlier sanctions it was exempted, so the world's buyers and bodies have a genuine, self-interested stake in its survival; it is a bulwark against the desert within the Great Green Wall, drawing international backing; and its communities tend and restore it even now, as the seedlings going into Kordofan attest. Its limits are equally real and must be stated: the war loots and disrupts it, much of the belt is out of production, its supply chain is opaque and hard to trace, and even in peace the gum was so undervalued that growers felled their acacias for charcoal or left for the gold mines. Understanding both means using the gum-belt front for what it does best — supporting the community restoration, securing fair farmgate prices that keep the trees standing, and building a traceable, conflict-free supply chain the world's buyers uphold — while recognising that the war and the undervaluation are real, so the work is patient and centred on the safe, and its aim is to make the belt worth more standing than felled, to the grower and to the world alike.

The Nile, the Dams, and the Water

The second front is the Nile. The **Nile and its dams — vital for the power, agriculture, and water of a nation, and now damaged and endangered by the war — and the wider water and irrigation** can be safeguarded through the **dam-safety and protection concerns, the water governance, the transboundary cooperation, and the international and humanitarian water frameworks**. Use the Nile, the dams, and the water, because the dams that provide much of the nation's power and water have been damaged and imperilled by the fighting, and safeguarding them — pressing for their protection from attack, for dam-safety, and for the water governance and cooperation the Nile requires — is the defence of the lifeblood of a nation and a matter the international and the region have reason to address.

The Gold, the Mercury, and the War Economy

The third front is the gold. The **gold mining that scars the land, poisons it with mercury, and — like the gum — is looted and smuggled to finance the war** can be confronted through the **mercury and**

contamination frameworks, the responsible-sourcing and traceability standards, and the international attention to conflict-financing. Press the gold, the mercury, and the war economy, because the gold, like the gum, is both an environmental harm and a fuel of the war, so confronting its mercury contamination and insisting on responsible, traceable, conflict-free sourcing serves at once the land, the health, and the cause of peace — the same traceability that protects the gum belt can help drain the war of its financing. Pursued together — the gum belt, the Nile, and the gold — these fronts are how a Sudanese effort protects the belt, safeguards the Nile, confronts the gold, and holds back the desert, through the international, the buyers, the UN, and the community, safely.

TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence does not speak for itself; you must aim it at each partner in the language that moves them. The same file of harm and global value becomes different arguments for the international bodies, the world's buyers, the UN, the community, and the diaspora. Translate deliberately, and always safely and centred on what is treasured and reachable.

For the International and Desertification Bodies

The international and desertification bodies respond to **the global value, the desertification stakes, and the Great Green Wall.** Frame the harm as a threat to a resource of global importance and a bulwark against the desert: here is the gum belt, its value to the world, its role in the Great Green Wall, the frameworks that protect it. Give them the documented harm and the value, and press for the restoration, the desertification, and the support. A desertification or international body charged with the Sahel and the Great Green Wall can act, even in a war-torn state.

For the World's Buyers

The world's buyers respond to **the supply, the reputation, and the due diligence.** Frame the harm as a matter of their own supply and responsibility: here is the belt they depend on, the looting and conflict-financing tainting the trade, the traceable and conflict-free sourcing that protects both the belt and their own integrity. Give them the case, and press for responsible sourcing, fair prices, and support for restoration. A buyer that depends on the gum has a real stake in a sustainable, conflict-free belt.

For the UN and Humanitarian Bodies

The UN and humanitarian bodies respond to **the crisis, the coordination, and the conflict-financing.** Frame the harm as a matter for the UN's coordination and the humanitarian-environment and conflict-financing link: here is the belt, the dams, the gold, the war economy they can address. Give them the case, and press for the water, restoration, and sourcing support. A UN body seized of the crisis and the conflict-financing can address the belt, the dams, and the gold.

For the Community and Diaspora

The community and diaspora respond to **the belt, the land, and the tangible good.** Translate the file into the story of a treasured belt and a threatened land: here is the acacia our people tend, the desert we must hold back, the Nile we depend on. Frame it as the defence of Sudan's land and the world's gum belt. Keep it accurate and safe; and speak to the diaspora's love of home and the community's stewardship.

The Golden Rule

Never fabricate, never exaggerate, centre on what is treasured and safe, and protect everyone. Your credibility rests on the real harm and the real global value — the international, commodity, and community case, safe and centred on the reachable; and the safety of everyone is paramount in a nation at war. State the harm precisely, tie it to the gum belt, the Nile, or the gold, and press through the international, the buyers, the UN, the community, and the diaspora. An effort that is precise, value-grounded, and safe is far more effective than one that overreaches, and far safer than any that would endanger someone in the war-torn interior.

STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Media and attention convert your evidence into support — and here, for a nation at war, the domestic space is broken and dangerous, so the "media" that works is the international coverage and the diaspora's voice that reach the world's surprising dependence on the gum belt and its concern for a nation in crisis, always safely. The story — a hidden ingredient in the world's soft drinks and medicines, tapped from acacia trees that hold back the desert, now looted to finance a war — resonates powerfully worldwide, if told carefully and safely.

Why Media Matters

The international bodies, the world's buyers, the UN, and the world behave differently when the treasure and the harm are visible. Media does three things here: it **connects the world to its own dependence on the gum belt**, it **raises the support** for a treasured belt and a nation in crisis, and it **reaches the bodies, the buyers, the UN, and the diaspora**. But the domestic space is broken and dangerous, so the media effort runs through **international coverage, the diaspora's voice, and careful, safe documentation**, protecting everyone, and centring on the globally valued and reachable belt.

Crafting Your Narrative

Lead with the gum belt and the desert. The strongest frame is surprising, concrete, and true: *a hidden ingredient in a great share of the world's soft drinks, sweets, and medicines — tapped from acacia trees across a belt the size of France that also holds back the Sahara — now looted and smuggled to finance a war, its forests felled, its growers dispossessed*. Put the world's dependence on the gum belt and its role against the desert first, because the story of an unsung global treasure imperilled by war is powerful and internationally resonant, and it gives the world's buyers and publics a real stake. Keep it scrupulously accurate and safe; and never endanger anyone in the interior. The Sudanese story is powerful because the gum belt is a hidden global treasure, its role against the desert vital, and its looting a fuel of the war.

Choosing Your Channels

Match the channel to the audience, all external and safe. **International coverage and the diaspora's networks** for the world and the diaspora; **the commodity, business, and food-industry media** for the buyers; **the environmental and desertification channels** for the belt and the desert; and **the community networks** where safe. Because the gum belt is a hidden global treasure and its story surprising, the international channels carry it powerfully, and the safety of everyone comes first — the world's dependence on the belt and its role against the desert are the story's power.

A Few Cautions

Stay accurate, safe, external, and centred on the treasured — the aim is protecting the belt, safeguarding the Nile, confronting the gold, and holding back the desert, framed around the gum belt, the Nile, and the

gold, and never anything that could endanger anyone in the war-torn interior. Frame the story around the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, and the desert, and handle the war, the parties, the division, and the geopolitics factually and from the safety of outside, keeping the focus on the environment and the treasured belt. Handle the sensitive matters through the careful international record, never through anything that could endanger a person inside. And sustain the story across the slow work. Above all, let the hidden global treasure of the gum belt, its role against the desert, and the world's own dependence on it carry the story, because that is where a Sudanese effort is strongest and safest.

EMAILS & LETTERS: TEMPLATES THAT WORK

Templates save time and prevent mistakes, but adapt every one — insert the real resource and harm, keep it factual and safe, centre on what is treasured, and protect everyone. Here the world's buyers, the international and desertification frameworks, and the community win. These are addressed to partners and bodies, not to anyone endangered.

8A: To an International or Desertification Body

Subject: The gum belt and the desert under threat in [area]

To [desertification / international body],

We write regarding the looting, felling, and loss of the acacia gum belt in [area] — a global source of gum arabic and a bulwark against the desert within the Great Green Wall. We respectfully seek the engagement of the desertification and international frameworks and support for the community restoration. We attach the evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

8B: The Gum Belt / Restoration & Supply-Chain Case

Subject: Restoring the acacia belt and securing conflict-free sourcing in [area]

To [restoration partner / buyer],

The gum belt in [area] is looted and felled, its sourcing tainted by conflict. We respectfully seek support for community restoration — seedlings, sustainable tapping — fair farmgate prices that keep the trees standing, and a traceable, conflict-free supply chain. We attach the assessment.

Respectfully,

[Name, community effort, contact]

8C: To a Global Buyer of Gum Arabic

Subject: Responsible, conflict-free sourcing of gum arabic

To [company / buyer],

Your products depend on gum arabic from Sudan's acacia belt, now looted and smuggled to finance the war and threatened by felling and drought. We respectfully urge responsible, traceable, conflict-free sourcing, fair prices to the growers, and support for restoration — protecting both the belt and your own integrity. We attach the documentation.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

8D: The Nile / Dams Case

Subject: Safeguarding the [dam] and the Nile at [location]

To [UN / water body],

The [dam] at [location], vital for power and water, has been damaged and endangered by the war. We respectfully seek engagement for its protection from attack, dam-safety, and the water governance and cooperation the Nile requires. We attach the evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

8E: The Gold / Mercury / Sourcing Case

Subject: Confronting the mercury and conflict-sourcing of gold at [location]

To [environment / sourcing body],

The gold mining at [location] poisons the land with mercury and is looted to finance the war. We respectfully urge the mercury and contamination frameworks and responsible, traceable, conflict-free sourcing. We attach the evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

8F: To an International Scientist or Forestry Body

Subject: The science of the gum belt and its restoration in [area]

Dear [research / forestry body],

We write regarding the loss and restoration of the acacia gum belt in [area] and respectfully seek your scientific and forestry engagement — the studies, the restoration, and the support for the community — in defence of a global treasure and a wall against the desert. We provide the documentation.

Respectfully,

[Name, community effort, contact]

8G: Media / Documentation Pitch

Subject: The hidden ingredient holding back the desert — imperilled by war

Dear [journalist / editor],

Across Sudan's acacia belt — the size of France — grows the source of most of the world's gum arabic, a hidden ingredient in soft drinks, sweets, and medicines, and a bulwark against the Sahara. Now it is looted to finance a war, its forests felled, even as seedlings go into the ground. There is a surprising, urgent, resonant story here, and we can provide the science, the community's voices, and the global dimension, safely.

Sincerely,

[Name, contact]

8H: To the Gum-Belt Community and Diaspora

Subject: Our acacia belt, our land — let us protect it

Dear friends,

Our acacia belt — the source of the world's gum arabic, the living of millions, and our wall against the desert — is looted, felled, and imperilled by the war. But we are the people who tend this treasure, and with the world's buyers, the international bodies, and our diaspora behind us, we can protect and restore it — planting the seedlings, tending the trees, and keeping the desert at bay. Please join us, safely and together, in defending our belt and our land.

With respect,

[Name / community]

IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Sometimes an effort is acute — a forest being looted or felled, a dam endangered, a mine poisoning a water source, a shipment of conflict gum reaching a buyer — and you cannot run the full effort. Triage to the levers that work fastest and most safely here, which means the community restoration, the world's buyers and the supply chain, and the international bodies, protecting everyone.

The First 48 Hours

Establish the essentials: **what is threatened, and what framework can defend it**. Identify the immediate harm — **a forest being looted, a dam endangered, a mine poisoning, a conflict-gum shipment** — because that is what you must affect first. Reach the **gum-belt community where safe, the world's buyers, and the international and UN bodies** at once, because in Sudan the community restoration, the supply chain and buyers, and the international bodies are the fastest routes to real leverage — and keep everyone safe from the start, centring on what is safe and treasured.

The Fastest-Moving Levers

Some levers work faster than others. **The world's buyers and the supply chain** can act quickly on a conflict-tainted shipment or a sourcing commitment. **The community restoration** can begin where it is safe, as the seedlings show. **The international and desertification bodies** can be alerted fast to a threat to the belt. **The diaspora** can mobilise quickly around the belt. These outpace the slower work of the deep restoration and the Nile and gold reform — which must follow — because the buyers, the community, and the international bodies can be brought to bear immediately. Above all, if the gum belt or a conflict-gum shipment is at issue, engage the world's buyers and the supply chain fast, because the world's dependence on the belt is a lever it responds to.

Emergency Coalition-Building

You cannot build a full coalition overnight, but for Sudan you can reach the community, the world's buyers, and the international bodies fast, and safely. Reach immediately to the **gum-belt community where safe, the world's buyers, and the international and UN bodies**, protecting everyone. A coalition supporting the

community restoration, engaging the buyers and the supply chain, and alerting the international bodies is the most a rapid Sudanese effort can do. Speed favours the prepared: know the treasure, the framework, and the safe channels before the crisis breaks, and centre on the safe and treasured.

WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Here, honestly, the field is tilted about as far as any in this series, by a war that has divided the state and consumed much of the country, by a war economy in which the gum belt and the gold are looted and smuggled to finance the fighting, by a humanitarian catastrophe that overwhelms all, and by an undervaluation and dispossession that were bleeding the belt even before the war. Name it plainly, because pretending the country is at peace, or that the gum trade is untouched, or that the war economy does not shape it all, would each be false — but the global stake in the gum belt, the world's buyers, the international and desertification frameworks, the community, and the diaspora make even this deeply tilted field one where careful, safe, treasure-centred work can take hold.

Recognising a Tilted Field

The signs are specific and honest. **The state is divided by war** — no unified government to lead. **The war economy loots the belt and the gold** — the commodities financing the fighting. **The humanitarian catastrophe overwhelms** — the crisis consumes all. **And the belt was undervalued even in peace** — its growers driven to charcoal and the mines. But **the global stake in the gum belt, the world's buyers, the international and desertification frameworks, the community, and the diaspora** are real levers. This is a tilt about as steep as any, worked through the globally valued belt, the buyers, the international frameworks, the community, and the diaspora, protecting everyone, not through a unified state that does not exist.

Strategies for a Tilted Field

When the field is this tilted, use the treasure, the buyers, and the international levers. Lean on the **gum belt**, a global treasure the world depends on; the **world's buyers**, whose stake in a sustainable, conflict-free belt is real; the **international and desertification frameworks**, which uphold the Great Green Wall; the **community restoration**, which continues even amid war; and the **diaspora**, which acts where the interior cannot. Meet the war and the war economy not with confrontation but with the defence of the belt, the traceable and conflict-free sourcing that drains the war of its financing, the fair prices that keep the trees standing, and the restoration that holds back the desert. And build the community, buyer, and international coalition over time, because these accumulate into real, if partial, defence. A field tilted this far is worked through the belt, the buyers, and the international, protecting everyone, not through a state broken by war.

The Honest Possibility of Losing

You may achieve little against the vast crisis — the war may grind on, the belt may keep bleeding, the desert may keep advancing — and this guide will not pretend otherwise; the tilt is among the steepest and the war economy deep. But even here the work is rarely wholly wasted: the **belt was documented, the restoration supported, the buyers engaged, the sourcing made traceable, and the world's attention won** — and every forest restored, every seedling planted, every shipment made conflict-free, every measure that holds back the desert makes a real difference and preserves a piece of a global treasure and a wall against the Sahara. Press, safely and centred on the treasured, for the belt and the desert; even amid the war, the trees you help restore and the sourcing you help clean, as the seedlings and the buyers' concern prove, are real and lasting goods — for a treasure the world depends on, once protected, is protected for all.

WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — AND WHO BENEFITS

In Sudan, alongside the honest tilt of war and crisis, there is a real and central dimension of a war economy, because the gum arabic and the gold — the country's environmental treasures — are looted, smuggled, and trafficked through opaque, hard-to-trace supply chains to finance the fighting, so that the very resources this guide seeks to protect are also the fuel of the war and the profit of armed actors. The harm here is partly the plunder of the belt and the gold by the powers of the war, and the tainting of a global trade. The response runs through the traceability, the responsible sourcing, and the international scrutiny.

Telling the War Economy from the Ordinary Tilt

Here the harm is a war economy, and its marks are specific: **the gum and the gold looted and smuggled to finance the war, the opaque, hard-to-trace supply chains exploited by armed actors, the growers dispossessed and the trade trafficked across borders without certification, and the world's buyers unwittingly sourcing conflict commodities**. The task is to document it and reach it through the traceability, the responsible sourcing, and the international scrutiny, relying on the international reporting, the supply-chain data, and the world's buyers, and keeping strictly to the environmental and the sourcing and protecting everyone. And note that the same traceability and responsible sourcing that protect the gum belt and the gold from plunder can help drain the war of its financing — so the environmental and the peace levers are here one.

Responding to the War Economy — Through Traceability and the Buyers

Where the war economy is real, the response runs through the traceability and the buyers. Use the **traceability and responsible-sourcing standards** to insist that the gum and the gold reaching the world are conflict-free. Use the **world's buyers and their due diligence** to refuse the conflict commodities and support the growers directly. Use the **international reporting and scrutiny** to expose the looting and smuggling. And use the **community and the fair prices** to keep the trees standing and the growers from dispossession. Document rigorously, keep strictly to the environmental and the sourcing, and protect everyone, for in a war zone the record must be international and the people shielded. Route the effort through the traceability, the responsible sourcing, and the international scrutiny — never through interior confrontation, which is impossible and dangerous.

A Note on Safety and Protection

This note matters greatly here, and governs everything. Sudan is a nation at war, its state divided and much of it consumed by one of the world's worst humanitarian crises, so this work must protect everyone involved absolutely and centre on what is safe — above all the globally valued gum belt where communities can act, the world's buyers, and the international frameworks. Work through the **community, international, buyer, UN, and diaspora channels**, and only where it is safe; never expose or endanger anyone, and treat the safety of all involved as the first and overriding consideration; avoid the conflict areas; frame the work as the defence of a global treasure and a wall against the desert, never as a party to the war; and handle the parties, the division, and the geopolitics only through the careful international record, never through anything that could endanger a person. Protection here is not one concern among others but the governing rule: the effective and safe path for Sudan runs through the globally valued belt, the world's buyers, the international frameworks, and the community, and nothing — no restoration, no documentation, no appeal — is worth endangering a single person in a nation at war.

INTEGRATION & TIMELINE: RUNNING ALL FIVE STEPS TOGETHER

The steps in this guide are written in sequence but run in parallel, each feeding the others — all centred on the globally valued belt, international, community-based, and protective of everyone. Here is how they fit into a single Sudanese effort.

The Parallel Effort

From the start, the five run together. **Documentation** builds the harm-and-value file. **Target identification** aims it at the treasured and reachable levers. **Local opposition**, understood as the community-international-and-buyer coalition, organises the communities, the international bodies, the buyers, and the diaspora. **International, commodity, and land** work protects the belt, safeguards the Nile, and confronts the gold. **Media**, external and surprising, carries the gum-belt-and-desert cause. The harm-and-value feeds all five at once — a documented threat is a restoration effort, a supply-chain measure, an international appeal, and a community mobilisation together. Run in parallel, they compound; run one at a time, they stall — and here, centred on the treasured belt and safely, they compound into real, if partial, defence of the belt and the desert.

A Rough Timeline

Early (weeks 1–8): establish the harm and the global value; identify the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, and the desert; build the community-international-and-buyer coalition and begin documentation, safely. **Middle (months–years):** protect and restore the gum belt through the community and the supply chain; safeguard the Nile; confront the gold; and hold back the desert. **Later (years):** see the belt restored and its sourcing traceable, the Nile safeguarded where possible, the gold's harms confronted, and the desert held back — real, if partial, outcomes, as the seedlings and the buyers' stake show. A Sudanese effort works centred on the treasured belt and from outside, and its fruits are slow and hard-won; pace it accordingly, and let the safety of everyone govern every step.

The Core Discipline

Through it all, hold the discipline that gives these efforts their force: **document the harm and the global value; protect and restore the gum belt through agroforestry, fair livelihoods, and a traceable, conflict-free supply chain; safeguard the Nile and its dams; confront the gold's mercury and conflict-sourcing; hold back the desert through the belt and the Great Green Wall; use the international, UN, diaspora, and community channels; and protect everyone.** The coalition that presses all five, centred on the treasured belt and safely, is the one that can genuinely protect the belt and hold back the desert — the kind of result a vast, war-torn Sahelian and Nile nation allows, from outside and through the community.

FINAL ASSESSMENT

Defending the environment in Sudan is genuinely hard, and bound up with a war that has divided the state and consumed much of the country, a war economy that loots the gum and the gold to finance the fighting, a humanitarian catastrophe that overwhelms all, and an undervaluation that was bleeding the belt even before the war, and this guide has been honest about that from its first line: the country is at war, the belt disrupted and undervalued, the gold entangled, the dams damaged, and no swift victory exists. And yet the effort is far from futile, because the gum belt is a global treasure the world's buyers and bodies have a real stake in,

restorable through agroforestry and fair livelihoods and defensible through a traceable, conflict-free supply chain, because the Nile and its dams can be safeguarded, because the gold's harms can be confronted through the mercury and sourcing frameworks, because the desert can be held back through the belt and the Great Green Wall, and because the international, UN, diaspora, and community channels offer real avenues; and those levers of the gum belt, the Nile, the gold, the desert, and the channels are real.

Some honest truths hold across every effort here. **The gum belt is a hidden global treasure and a wall against the desert, the world's buyers have a stake, and restoration continues even amid war. The traceable, conflict-free supply chain serves both the belt and the cause of peace. The belt is disrupted and undervalued, and the gold entangled in the war. But the country is at war, and the work is external, safe, and community-based.** Hold both truths at once: real, distinctive levers of the globally valued belt and the international, and the honest weight of a nation at war and a war economy that plunders its treasures.

Above all, keep the discipline — and the safety — that give these efforts their force. Document the harm and the global value. Protect and restore the gum belt through agroforestry, fair livelihoods, and a traceable, conflict-free supply chain. Safeguard the Nile and its dams. Confront the gold's mercury and conflict-sourcing. Hold back the desert through the belt and the Great Green Wall. Use the international, UN, diaspora, and community channels. And protect everyone — because in a vast, war-torn Sahelian and Nile nation, an effort that protects the belt, safeguards the Nile, confronts the gold, and holds back the desert, centred on the treasured and safe and keeping everyone from harm, is the one that is both effective and just.

Sudan is a vast nation of Sahel and Nile, of desert and acacia, gripped by one of the world's worst wars and running with the largest displacement crisis on earth — and yet, stretched across its south-central lands, lies a belt of acacia trees the size of France whose sap is a hidden ingredient in a great share of the world's soft drinks, sweets, and medicines, whose harvest fed the livelihoods of millions, and whose canopy is a living wall against the Sahara. This guide has hidden none of the darkness — the war, the divided state, the looting and smuggling of the belt and the gold to finance the fighting, the damaged dams, the advancing desert — and there is no swift or landmark victory to promise you. But the gum belt is a treasure both of Sudan and of the world that depends on it, restorable tree by tree and defensible through a supply chain the world's buyers have every reason to keep clean; the Nile and its dams can be safeguarded; the gold's mercury and conflict-sourcing can be confronted; and the desert can be held back, seedling by seedling, along the Great Green Wall. Those are the levers, and they are real: the community restoration and the fair livelihoods that keep the acacias standing; the traceable, conflict-free sourcing that protects the belt and drains the war of its financing; the international and desertification frameworks and the world's buyers; and the vast diaspora that carries Sudan's cause to the world. There is no confrontation in a war-torn interior, no swift healing of a nation in crisis, and no work that is not shadowed by danger; this guide has said so throughout, and insisted above all on the safety of everyone. But the acacia belt and the Nile and the threatened land of Sudan are worth every careful, safe, treasure-centred effort, the levers that run through the belt and the international are real, and the patient, protective work of protecting and restoring the gum belt, safeguarding the Nile, confronting the gold, and holding back the desert is one that the gum-belt communities, the international bodies and the world's buyers, and the vast diaspora can genuinely do — and keep a hidden treasure of the world, and a wall against the Sahara, alive. So can you.